

Rhythm & Counting

Music moves in time. Learn the steady beat, how measures group those beats, and what the notes on the staff are asking you to do.

THE PULSE

Beat

The steady tick you feel — like a heartbeat. Tap your foot and you're already counting time.

A GROUP OF BEATS

Measure

Beats live in little boxes. Bar lines mark the walls. Each box is one measure.

SAY THE NUMBERS

Counting

In 4/4 time, count **1·2·3·4** and start again. Beat 1 is the strongest.

ONE MEASURE OF 4/4 · COUNT OUT LOUD



The **treble clef** curls around the second line from the bottom — that's G. The **4/4** means four quarter-note beats in every measure.



Point & count

Tap each number as you say it.

TIME SIGNATURE

What 4/4 means

4
4

Top number — how many beats in each measure.

Bottom number — which note gets one beat (4 = quarter note).

Common time (c) is another way to write 4/4.

Bar lines close each measure. A double bar often ends a section.

STAFF SECRETS



Treble clef

Also called the G clef. It tells you which notes live where on the five lines.

Bar line = end of a measure. **Rest** = silence for that many beats. Quiet counts too!

NOTE VALUES · HOW LONG EACH SHAPE LASTS IN 4/4



Whole

4 BEATS

Hold for the whole measure.



Half

2 BEATS

Open note head + stem.



Quarter

1 BEAT

Filled note head + stem.



Eighth

½ BEAT

Add a flag — or beam two.



Rest

1 BEAT SILENT

Quiet still counts!